

Stephen Dossou

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Citizenship: Benin

RESEARCH FIELDS

Primary: Entrepreneurial Finance, Venture Capital

Secondary: Contract Theory and Mechanism Design, Applied Econometrics

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, Mines Paris – PSL (CERNA, ED SDOSE)

2024 – expected 2027

Advisors: Pierre Fleckinger and Philippe Mustar

Diplôme d'Ingénieur (M.Sc. equivalent), CentraleSupélec

2020 – 2024

Information & Communication Engineering. Optimization, machine learning, network theory, quantitative modelling.

Classes Préparatoires (MPSI, MP*), Lycée Louis-le-Grand, Paris

2018 – 2020

Competitive undergraduate programme in advanced mathematics and physics.

JOB MARKET PAPER

“Avoiding the British: Brexit, Cross-Border Syndication, and the Identification of Mechanisms under Market-Wide Shocks”

Did Brexit break the co-investment ties between British and continental European venture capitalists? I summarize my findings. First, continental VCs with high pre-determined exposure to UK partners durably cut the share of their syndicates including a British investor by 8.2 percentage points against a base rate of 18.7%, and among thirteen partner-country corridors subjected to an identical, pre-specified protocol the United Kingdom is the only one to move. Second, established UK–continental dyads were no more likely to dissolve than comparable continental dyads (triple difference +0.3 pp, $p = 0.77$). Third, the aggregate volume of jointly syndicated deals tracked control corridors within $[-20\%, +26\%]$: the relationship thinned at the new-syndicate margin without existing ties rupturing or deal flow collapsing. To arrive at these conclusions, I set up an exposure-based event study on more than 1.2 million Crunchbase investor–round observations, control for small $\times$ post composition, and conduct inference by wild-cluster bootstrap with few clusters, running the same falsification protocol across every partner-country corridor. The methodological lesson comes last: when a market-wide shock treats every agent on the same date, designs without an untreated unit do not lose precision — they manufacture mechanisms.

WORKING PAPERS

“Pooling Contracts between Venture Capital Institutions” (with Pierre Fleckinger)

- An informed-principal framework for contracts between institutions in venture capital. Under ex-post commitment — the accelerator-to-VC relationship — the unique optimal contract is pooling with a binding budget constraint on the agency, and some positive-NPV projects are necessarily excluded. Under ex-ante commitment — the LP-to-VC relationship — the budget constraint is slack and all

profitable projects are financed in cash-rich economies. *JEL*: G24, G23, D82, D86.

“Bridge Financing under Accelerator Contracts: A Model of Y Combinator’s 2022 MFN SAFE Reform”

- A sequential financing game (accelerator, bridge investor, seed investor, entrepreneur) analysing the most-favored-nation clause in accelerator contracts. The equilibrium bridge share is independent of the amount bridged; the linear MFN is the unique detail-free schedule implementing the efficient cap-table overhang for every financing need; and the gain from a richer instrument is quadratic in the ratio of bridge needs to overhang value — nil on the empirically relevant domain.

POLICY REPORTS

“Devenir ETI : les chemins de la croissance”

June 2025

with Pierre Fleckinger, Philippe Mustar and Antoine Prévot.

Chaire etilab, Mines Paris – PSL. Report on the growth of French SMEs into mid-sized firms, combining firm-level statistical analysis, theory, and interviews with company executives.

PRESENTATIONS

EARIE (European Association for Research in Industrial Economics), Mannheim
Pooling Contracts between Venture Capital Institutions (scheduled)

August 2026

Internal doctoral workshop, Mines Paris – PSL (CERNA)

July 2026

Avoiding the British: Brexit, Cross-Border Syndication, and the Identification of Mechanisms

IOEA (Institute of Organizational Economics Academy), Cargèse
Pooling Contracts between Venture Capital Institutions

April 2026

Journée des Doctorants (joint with Université Paris-Dauphine), Mines Paris – PSL
Pooling Contracts between Venture Capital Institutions

March 2026

TEACHING

Microeconomics (undergraduate, first-year engineering cycle)

2024 – 2026

Teaching assistant (*travaux dirigés*), Mines Paris – PSL. Two academic years (2024–2025, 2025–2026); 6 hours of tutorials per year plus exam grading.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Mines Paris – PSL

Jan. 2024 – Oct. 2024

Research on startups and mid-sized firms in France; construction and analysis of large firm-level financial datasets.

Business Analyst (apprenticeship), Forvia

Sept. 2022 – Jan. 2024

Digital transformation initiatives in an industrial environment; operational monitoring tools.

Marketing Analyst (internship), Manda

Sept. 2021 – Jan. 2022

Acquisition strategy and performance analytics.

Data Scientist (internship), Onogone
Development and evaluation of NLP models.

July – Aug. 2021

SKILLS

Methods: Panel and event-study designs, difference-in-differences and triple differences, wild-cluster bootstrap inference with few clusters, falsification and placebo protocols, mechanism design and optimal control.

Software: Python, R, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Matlab.

Data: Crunchbase; construction of investor–round and dyad-level panels ($>1.2\text{M}$ investor–round observations).

LANGUAGES

French (native), English (C1).

REFERENCES

Pierre Fleckinger

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Philippe Mustar

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